

Buddhism reaching South East Asia

- Spread mainly through sea route, known as maritime trade route.
- Traders and monks on their way carried their religious accessories and ideas.
- Ashoka sent preachers to region like Sri Lanka to spread Buddhism.
- People at the trading area and ports adopted Buddhism and mixed them with their own cultures.

Important kingdoms or empire associated with Buddhism:

- Khmer Empire of Cambodia practices Hinduism as well as Buddhism.
- Srivijaya Empire was a major Buddhist learning center and trading hub. It was in Sumatra. Was founded by Dapunta Hyang Sri Jayanasa. Rulers like Balaputradeva supported Buddhism.
- Sailendra Dynasty built Borobudur. It is a famous Buddhist monument. This empire was founded by Sailendra family in Central Java. King Samaratungga played important role in Buddhism.
- Pagan Kingdom in Myanmar promoted Buddhism. a many temples were built there.

3. Items traded and Between Whom

- Trade connected India, Southeast Asia, China and Middle East.
- South east Asia exported spices, gold and timber.
- India traded cotton textiles, breads, and religious thoughts like Buddhism.
- China exported ~~silk~~ silk, tea, porcelain.
- Arab traded horses, dates and perfumes.
- ~~At this~~ Through this route culture, religion and knowledge were also exchanged.